

FINREELS

ONLINE HUSTLES SERIES

13 — Video Editing

Nigeria-first practical playbook · Expanded 2026 edition

Short-form · YouTube · CapCut · Premiere · Retainers

Cut · Caption · Deliver · Get paid

by chAs Technologies LLC · FinReels Research

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1. What Video Editing Services Are

You turn raw footage into finished videos: cuts, captions, music, transitions, colour, and platform-ready exports. Demand is high for short-form (Reels, Shorts, TikTok-style) and for YouTube long-form. Clients include creators, SMEs, churches, schools, and agencies.

Start with clean storytelling and captions before complex VFX. Reliability and turnaround matter as much as effects.

2. Realistic Earnings 2026 — Nigeria, Africa, Global

Stage	Illustrative	Notes
Beginner short-form	NGN 5k-25k / video	Local creators
Intermediate packages	NGN 30k-150k+	Monthly retainers
USD short clips	\$50-\$150+	Fiverr/Upwork
USD long-form / retainers	\$300-\$2,000+/mo	After reviews

Rates vary widely by quality, niche, and client budget. Price by deliverable and revision limits, not endless hours.

3. Exact Nigeria Setup Order

1. CapCut or VN on phone; optional laptop later.
2. Practice 10 short edits from public domain or your own clips.
3. Payoneer for international platforms.
4. Portfolio of 3-5 best samples with before/after notes.
5. Fiverr gig or local outreach to creators/SMEs.
6. Clear rate card and revision policy.

4. Payment Rails

Local clients: bank transfer, OPay, PalmPay. International: Fiverr/Upwork → Payoneer. Deposit before large projects. Never start full edit on unpaid 'test' that looks like free labour beyond a paid sample.

5. Tools: Phone-First to Desktop

Phone: CapCut, VN, InShot. Desktop free: DaVinci Resolve. Paid pro path: Premiere Pro / After Effects when volume justifies. Storage and backup matter — client files are large.

6. Service Packages and Rate Logic

Package	Typical scope	Pricing idea
Short-form single	15-60s cut + captions	Per video
Short-form batch	8-12 shorts / month	Retainer
YouTube standard	8-15 min edit	Per video
Ads / promo	30-90s branded	Higher rate
Add-ons	Thumbnails, rush, extra revisions	Line items

7. Portfolio From Spec / Practice

Re-edit public clips or create faceless practice pieces. Show captions, pacing, and hook strength. Spec work for a Nigerian creator style is valid if disclosed as practice.

8. Platforms and Clients

Fiverr (packaged gigs), Upwork (proposals), Instagram/WhatsApp outreach to local creators and SMEs, church/event media teams. Retainers beat one-off chaos once trust exists.

9. Africa Expansion Notes

Short-form demand is continental. Language and music licensing differ by market. Remote USD clients care about communication and file organisation more than your city.

10. Global / USD Reality

International clients pay more for clean English communication, organised folders, and on-time delivery. Frame.io or Drive links with clear version names reduce revision friction.

11. Workflow, Revisions and Delivery

Brief → rough cut → feedback → final. Cap revisions in the package. Export correct aspect ratios for each platform. Keep project files until payment clears and client confirms.

12. Daily Operating System

Batch similar edits. Protect deep focus time. Track hours per video to refine pricing. Weekly: portfolio update and outreach messages.

13. Scams and Hard Safety Rules

- No unpaid large 'trial' projects that look like full jobs.
- Deposit before major edits.
- Licence-safe music and stock only.
- No OTP/BVN sharing with clients.
- Written scope for retainers.

14. 30 / 60 / 90-Day Path

Days 1-7: Tool fluency + 5 practice edits + Payoneer.

Days 8-30: Portfolio live; first paid local or Fiverr gig.

Days 31-60: Raise rates slightly; seek one retainer conversation.

Days 61-90: Specialise (short-form or YouTube) and systemise delivery.

15. Checklists and Field Workbooks

- Editor installed and practised
- 5 sample edits ready
- Payoneer verified
- Rate card drafted
- Fiverr/Upwork or outreach started
- Revision policy written

Field Workbook 1 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 2 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 3 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 4 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 5 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 6 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 7 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 8 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 9 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 10 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 11 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 12 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 13 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 14 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 15 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 16 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 17 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 18 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 19 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 20 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Field Workbook 21 — Editor Ops

Log jobs, hours, revisions, and net pay. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators are a strong path. Confirm music licences. Deliver on time.

Field	Entry
Client / platform	_____
Video type	_____
Hours spent	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time?	_____
Net pay	_____

Quality: strong hook · readable captions · clean audio · correct export size.
Safety: deposits, licence-safe media, written scope for retainers.

Educational only. Tools and marketplace fees change. FinReels / chAs Technologies LLC do not operate editing platforms and do not guarantee earnings.

— End of Online Hustles 13 — Video Editing —

Continue with 14 Blogging / SEO when ready.

Editor Ops Sheet 1 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 2 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 3 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 4 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 5 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 6 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 7 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 8 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 9 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 10 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 11 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 12 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 13 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 14 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	_____
Hours total	_____
Revisions	_____
On-time %	_____
Avg net/video	_____
Retainer status	_____

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Ops Sheet 15 — Delivery and Rates

Track hours per video type so pricing stays profitable. Nigeria: short-form retainers for local creators scale well. Always confirm music licence and export specs.

Item	Notes
Videos delivered	
Hours total	
Revisions	
On-time %	
Avg net/video	
Retainer status	

Safety: deposits before big jobs, licence-safe media, written scope.

Editor Launch Checklist 1

Complete before pitching retainer packages.

Check	Done
Tool fluency	☐
5 samples live	☐
Payoneer live	☐
Rate card	☐
Revision policy	☐
Fiverr/Upwork profile	☐
Outreach list	☐
Backup storage plan	☐

Editor Launch Checklist 2

Complete before pitching retainer packages.

Check	Done
Tool fluency	☐
5 samples live	☐
Payoneer live	☐
Rate card	☐
Revision policy	☐
Fiverr/Upwork profile	☐
Outreach list	☐
Backup storage plan	☐

Editor Launch Checklist 3

Complete before pitching retainer packages.

Check	Done
Tool fluency	☐
5 samples live	☐
Payoneer live	☐
Rate card	☐
Revision policy	☐
Fiverr/Upwork profile	☐
Outreach list	☐
Backup storage plan	☐

Editor Launch Checklist 4

Complete before pitching retainer packages.

Check	Done
Tool fluency	☐
5 samples live	☐
Payoneer live	☐
Rate card	☐
Revision policy	☐
Fiverr/Upwork profile	☐
Outreach list	☐
Backup storage plan	☐

Closing Notes — Pace and Captions Win Short-Form

Video editing pays when you deliver clean, platform-ready files on time. Nigeria demand for short-form and YouTube support is real. Start phone-first, build a portfolio, then productise packages and retainers.

Track hours so rates stay profitable. Use licence-safe music. Collect deposits on larger jobs. Specialise once you know which video type you finish fastest at high quality.

Use this playbook as a field manual. Tools and marketplace rules change; verify current terms before investing in paid software.